

LINKEDIN TALENT INSIGHTS · EXACT SCIENCES

# Systems Development Talent Pool Report

Embedded Systems Engineer · United States · May 14, 2026

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Filter: Title  
Embedded System Engineer

Filter: Location  
United States

Distribution  
Internal only

- LinkedIn rates this talent pool as **Very High** hiring demand — classified as very hard to hire nationally.

Pool overview

TOTAL PROFESSIONALS

1,721

▲ 4% year-over-year

CHANGED JOBS (1YR)

348

20% turnover rate

OPEN JOB POSTS

169

~10 candidates per post

ENGAGED W/ EXACT SCIENCES

11

Only 1% of total pool

Geographic landscape



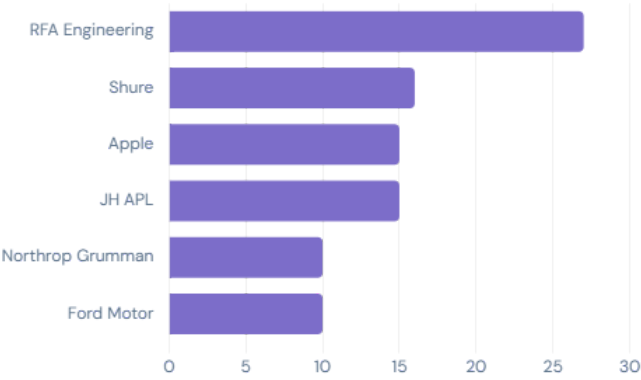
⚠ MADISON, WI DOES NOT APPEAR IN ANY MARKET DATA

The local talent pool is too small to register in LinkedIn's top markets. This confirms local hiring will be extremely competitive and will likely require relocation packages, expanded search radius, or remote-eligible role design.

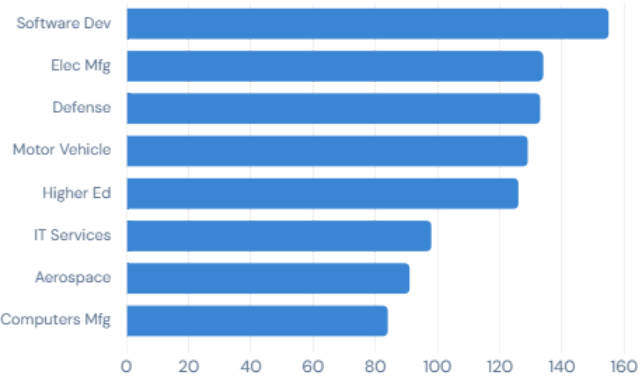
**Nearest addressable markets:** Greater Chicago Area (61 professionals, High demand, "hidden gem") and Detroit Metropolitan Area (60 professionals, Moderate demand, "hidden gem").

Who holds this talent

TOP EMPLOYERS BY EMBEDDED HEADCOUNT

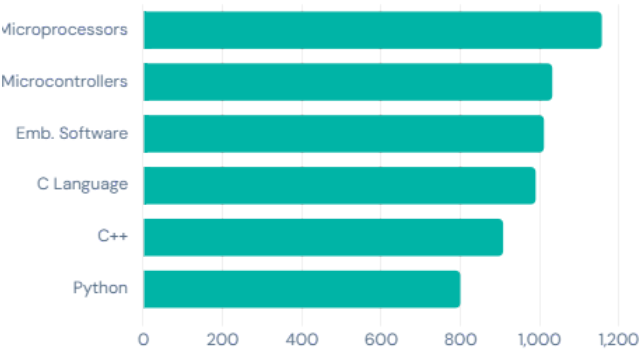


TOP INDUSTRIES EMPLOYING THIS TALENT

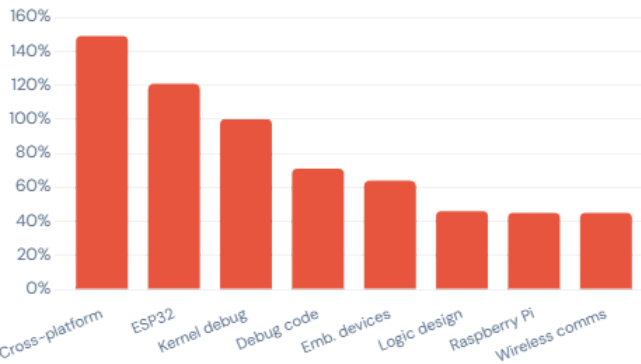


Skills landscape

MOST COMMON SKILLS IN POOL

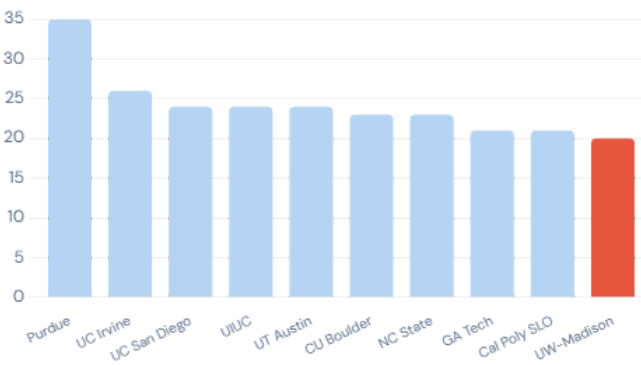


FASTEST GROWING SKILLS (1YR) — WHERE THE FIELD IS HEADING

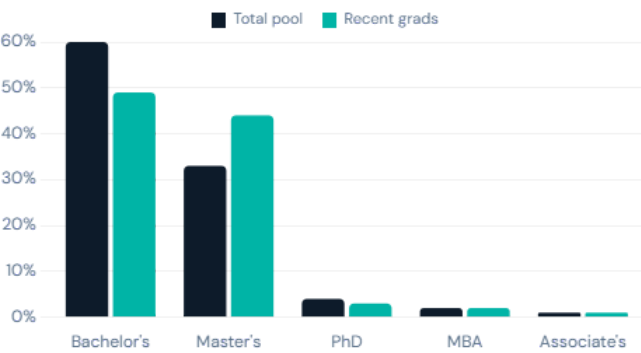


Education pipeline

TOP UNIVERSITIES PRODUCING THIS TALENT (UW-MADISON HIGHLIGHTED)



DEGREE LEVELS — TOTAL POOL VS. RECENT GRADS



Exact Sciences brand engagement with this pool

MONTHLY ENGAGEMENT BY THIS TALENT POOL WITH EXACT SCIENCES ON LINKEDIN (MAY 2025 – APR 2026)



BRAND AWARENESS GAP

Only 11 professionals (1% of pool) engaged with Exact Sciences on LinkedIn in the past 12 months. Zero InMails have been sent to this talent group. The company is essentially unknown to this audience.

JOB ENGAGEMENT

14% view-to-apply rate on job posts (2 clicks / 14 views). The 1-year median is 0% — any recent posting is performing above baseline, but sample size is too small to be significant.

Key takeaways for hiring leadership

LOCAL PIPELINE — ACTIVATE NOW

UW–Madison ranks #10 nationally with 20 professionals and 5 recent grads in this talent pool. A campus partnership or on-campus presence could give Exact Sciences a first-mover advantage locally.

HIDDEN GEM MARKETS

Chicago (61 professionals, lower competition) and Detroit (60, Moderate demand) are LinkedIn's flagged "hidden gem" markets — more supply relative to hiring pressure. Strong relocation pitch targets.

COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Shure (Chicago) grew their embedded headcount 33% in one year. Defense/Aerospace grew 13–17%. These are the primary competitors for this talent pool and they're moving fast.

SKILL EVOLUTION SIGNAL

Cross-platform development (+149%), ESP32 (+121%), and Kernel Debugging (+100%) are the fastest-growing skills — indicating the field is shifting toward connected, IoT-adjacent embedded work. Job descriptions should reflect this.

GRADUATE PIPELINE GROWING

Higher Education is the fastest-growing industry sector for this pool (+29% YoY), signaling increased graduate program output. Partnerships with top 10 feeder schools will pay off in 2–3 years.

DATA SCOPE CAVEAT

This report used one title only. The true addressable pool (including Firmware Engineer, Embedded Software Engineer, Platform Software Engineer) is estimated 3–5x larger. A broader filter is recommended for a complete picture.

IMPORTANT DATA CAVEATS

**LinkedIn undercounts embedded talent.** Embedded and firmware engineers are less active on LinkedIn than software generalists — they skew toward hardware-adjacent roles at defense contractors and manufacturers with non-disclosure cultures. The actual supply is likely 60–75% of what LinkedIn shows, not more.

**Gender data coverage is 92%** of the pool. This talent is 88% male / 12% female based on LinkedIn's inferred gender data — one of the least gender-diverse technical disciplines. Diversity sourcing strategies should plan for this constraint.

**Compensation data unavailable** due to low coverage in this pool. External benchmarking (Levels.fyi, Radford, Mercer) is recommended before extending offers.

United States · Data reflects LinkedIn member profiles only and undercounts professionals inactive on the platform · All use subject to LinkedIn Subscription Agreement and Service Terms.